

Challenge:	Invisible Ink
Category:	Steganography → Invisible Text / Hidden Document Metadata
Difficulty:	Easy
Tools Used:	Challenge URL: https://skill-issue-eight.vercel.app/

Summary

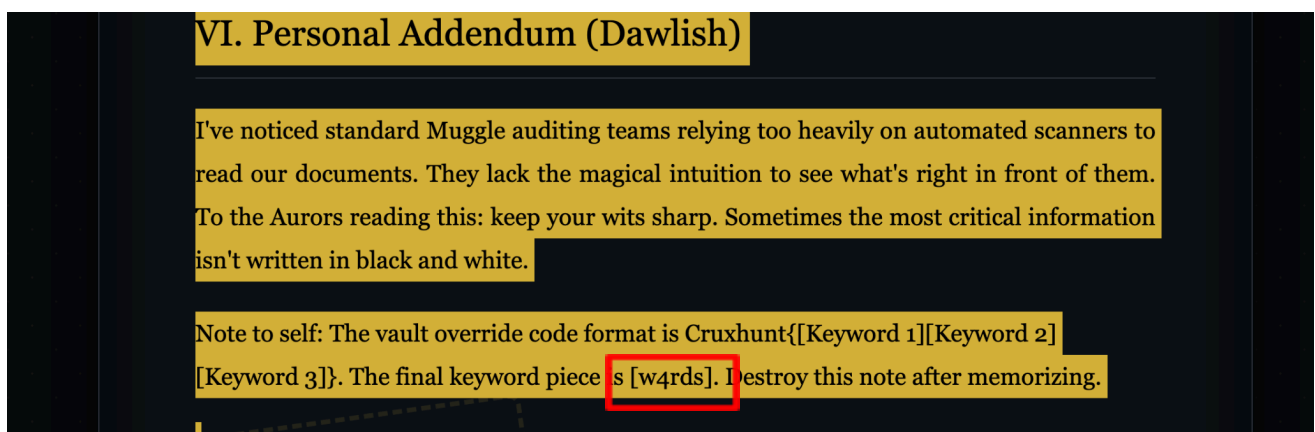
This challenge demonstrates a classic web steganography technique where text is hidden by setting its font color identical to the page background. A classified Ministry of Magic document — a Gringotts security protocol authored by Head Auror J. Dawlish — contained three hidden text fragments invisible to the naked eye unless selected or highlighted. Two fragments were embedded mid-document and one was hidden in a personal addendum at the bottom. The addendum also revealed the flag format and the correct assembly order of the three keywords.

Problem Statement

A classified document recovered from the marketplace describes outdated security practices. Large portions appear incomplete, as if critical details were never written — or intentionally concealed. The Ministry has historically used unconventional methods to obscure sensitive information. Not everything hidden is encrypted.

Steps to Solve

1. Identify the Steganography Technique - The problem statement gives the biggest hint: “Invisible Ink” and “Not everything hidden is encrypted.” This points away from cryptographic challenges and toward visual/HTML-based concealment. The technique here is CSS color-matching — hidden text set to the same color as the background.
2. Reveal the Hidden Text - Open the challenge URL: <https://skill-issue-eight.vercel.app/>
Press Ctrl+A (Select All) or click and drag across the “empty” sections of the page. The browser highlights all text, including invisible same-colored text, revealing three hidden fragments:
3. Read the Hidden Addendum - Dawlish’s personal addendum at the bottom of the document is also hidden using the same same-color technique. Selecting all text reveals it in full:



This note does two things: it reveals the flag format and confirms **[w4rds]** is Keyword 3. Combined with the document order of the other two fragments, the full assembly becomes clear:

IV. Goblin Relations and Access Codes

Gornuk and Griphook are currently the only authorized Goblin key-masters for the deep vaults. Ministry personnel are not to touch the vault doors under any circumstances. The doors are charmed to physically consume anyone attempting to open them without the proper Goblin lineage and magical signature. If a key-master is unavailable, you will wait.

Furthermore, the rotating cipher mechanism for the mid-level vaults changes every 12 hours. Do not attempt to write these ciphers down. You must commit them to memory. Any parchment found containing written ciphers will be immediately confiscated and incinerated by the Department of Magical Accidents and Catastrophes. **[s3cur3_]**

II. Dragon Care and Deterrence

The Ukrainian Ironbelly stationed at Vault 713 has shown increased signs of agitation following the implementation of the new clanking mechanisms. The frequency of the Clankers has been recalibrated to 432Hz to better resonate with the beast's inner ear. Aurors are reminded that the Ironbelly is not a pet. Unauthorized feeding, particularly of Ministry-issued owls, is strictly prohibited and will be docked from the offending Auror's monthly Galleon stipend. **[m4g1c_]**

In the event of a chain failure, Aurors are to immediately cast the *Arresto Momentum* charm on the falling debris, not the dragon. The dragon is highly resistant to standard stunning spells; your priority is ensuring the structural integrity of the stalactites preventing a cave-in to the lower lava flows.

4. Once you find all three fragments, do not blindly stick them together in numerical (1-2-3) order! Read the Bottom line carefully. It contains hidden instructions, the non-sequential order you must use to assemble the final flag.
5. Concatenating the three keywords in direct order would be misleading. Since we know that the last work is definitely w4rds, try switching the first two words :

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s3cur3_ + m4g1c_ + w4rds = s3cur3_m4g1c_w4rds
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6. Flag

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Cruxhunt{s3cur3_m4g1c_w4rds}
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